

Level Up

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(c) Reference group and anticipatory socialization.

(10 Marks)

Grisbert defines a social group as a unit of systems and procedures characteristic of group activity. A group forms when

like minded people $\xrightarrow{\text{come together}}$ perform meaningful task

Reference group ~~was~~ is a typology of social groups given by HERBERT HYMEN who noted that in certain societies

① Members desire to be part of another "IDEAL" reference group

② Members perform rituals, practices of other group

In India, Prof. M. Srinivas observed this phenomenon and called it Sanskritisation wherein a low caste/trope aims to achieve a status of higher caste (dwija)

by
 → giving up non-vegetarianism
 → wearing sacred thread, singing higher caste worship songs etc.

REASONS

① Push factors

- Lack of opportunities
- Discrimination
- Desire for better life style

② Pull factors

- better standard of living
- Higher social status
- Anticipation of socialisation with higher caste

→ Reference groups are an extreme form of Xenocentrism where other culture is preferred to own.

Some anthropologists have questioned the universality of reference groups and their vagueness as a concept.

However, rising access to information via media/technology is increasing the scope of reference groups and the anticipation of mobility.

Marks:

Comment:

Intro:

Body:

Conclusion:

Total:

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